A SOUND of THUNDER

COMIC VERSION BY AL WILLIAMSON

ADAPTED FROM THE STORY BY RAY BRADBURY

PART 2

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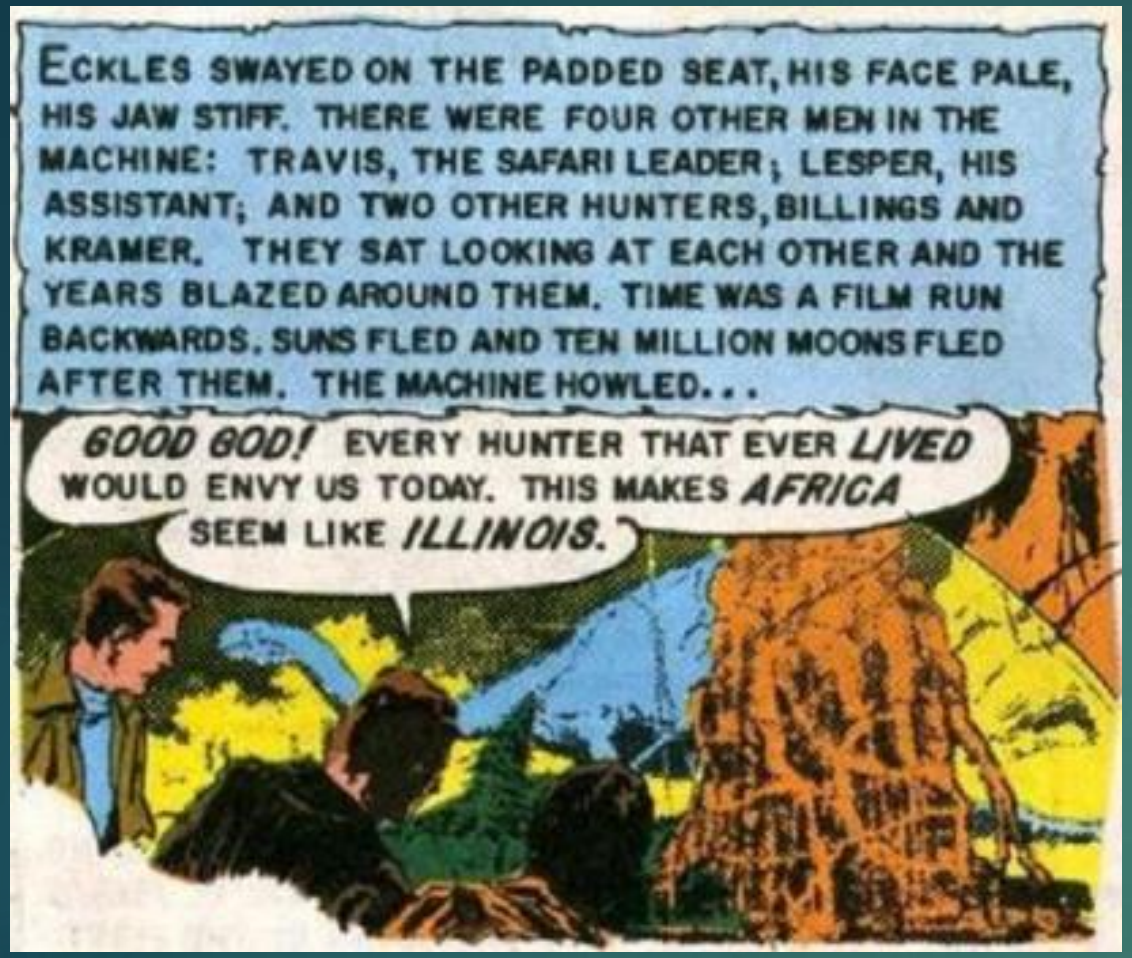
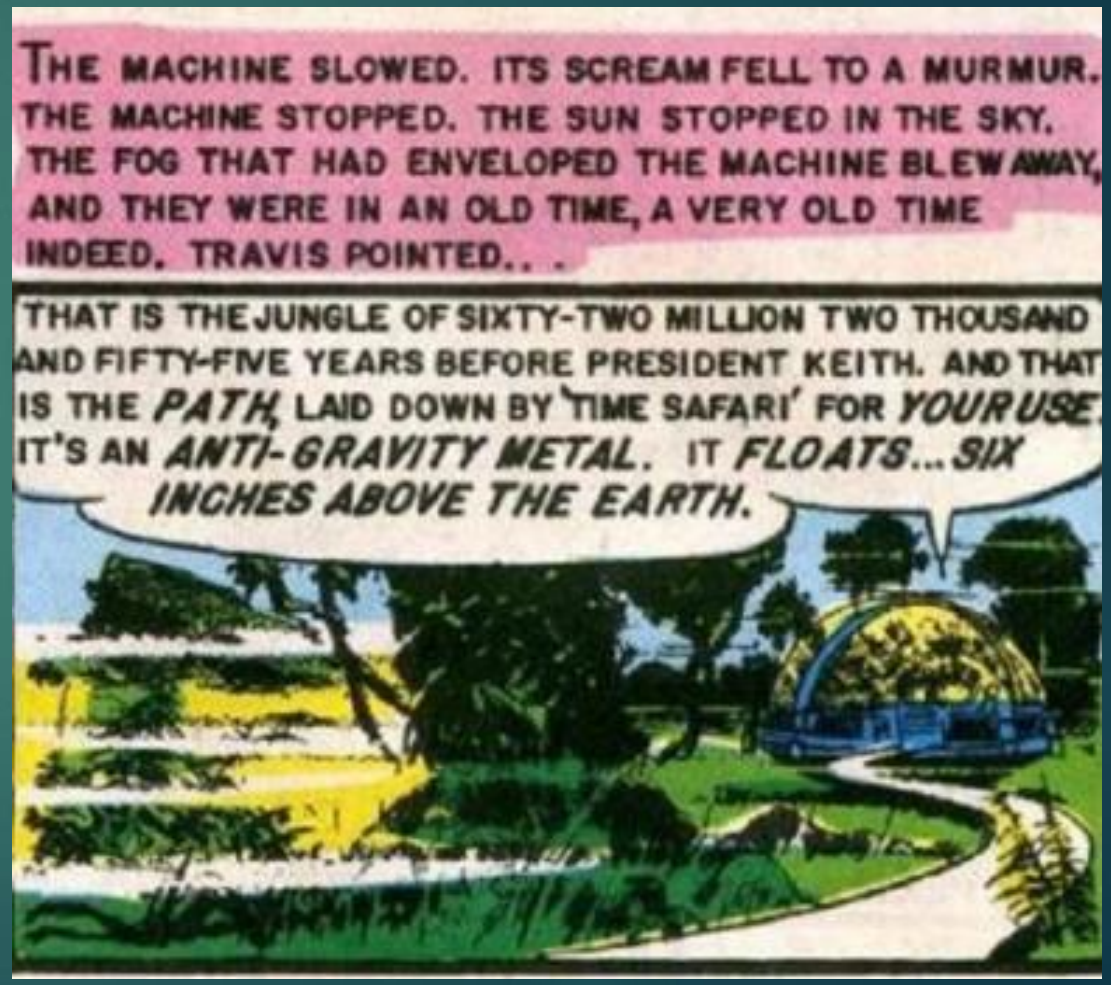
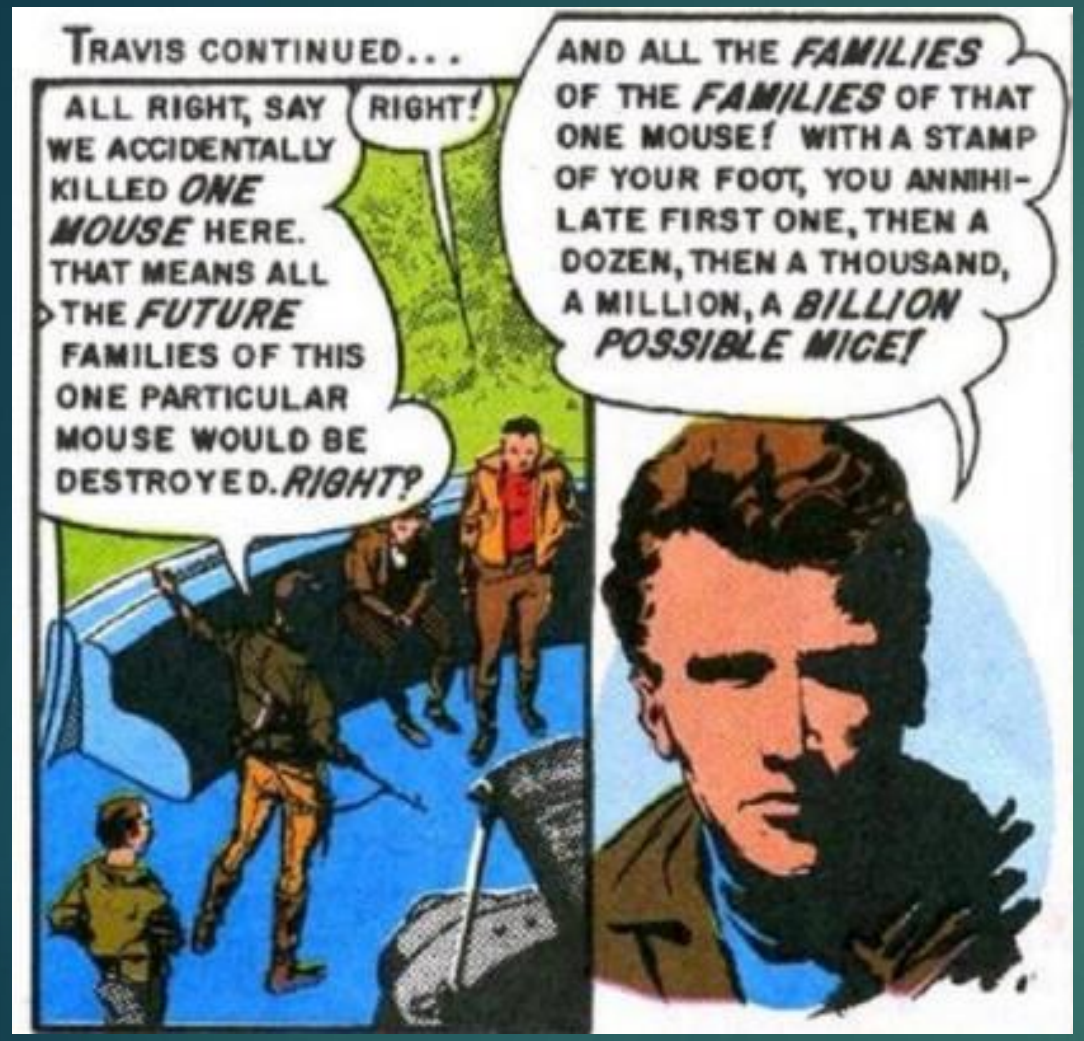
THEY MOVED SILENTLY ACROSS THE ROOM, TAKING THEIR GUNS WITH THEM, TOWARD THE MACHINE, TOWARD THE SILVER METAL AND THE ROARING LIGHT...

FIRST A DAY AND THEN A NIGHT AND THEN IT WAS DAY-NIGHT-DAY-NIGHT... A WEEK... A MONTH... A YEAR... A DECADE. 2056 A.D., 2019 A.D., 1999, 1954, GONE! THE MACHINE ROARED...


ECKLES SWAYED ON THE PADDED SEAT, HIS FACE PALE, HIS JAW STIFF. THERE WERE FOUR OTHER MEN IN THE MACHINE: TRAVIS, THE SAFARI LEADER; LESPER, HIS ASSISTANT; AND TWO OTHER HUNTERS, BILLINGS AND KRAMER. THEY SAT LOOKING AT EACH OTHER AND THE YEARS BLAZED AROUND THEM. TIME WAS A FILM RUN BACKWARDS. SUNS FLED AND TEN MILLION MOONS FLED AFTER THEM. THE MACHINE HOWLED...
GOOD GOD! EVERY HUNTER THAT EVER LIVED WOULD ENVY US TODAY. THIS MAKES AFRICA SEEM LIKE ILLINOIS.


THE MACHINE SLOWED. ITS SCREAM FELL TO A MURMUR. THE MACHINE STOPPED. THE SUN STOPPED IN THE SKY. THE FOG THAT HAD ENVELOPED THE MACHINE BLEW AWAY, AND THEY WERE IN AN OLD TIME, A VERY OLD TIME INDEED. TRAVIS POINTED...
THAT IS THE JUNGLE OF SIXTY-TWO MILLION TWO THOUSAND AND FIFTY-FIVE YEARS BEFORE PRESIDENT KEITH. AND THAT IS THE PATH, LAID DOWN BY 'TIME SAFARI' FOR YOUR USE. IT'S AN ANTI-GRAVITY METAL. IT FLOATS... SIX INCHES ABOVE THE EARTH.

IT DOESN'T TOUCH SO MUCH AS ONE GRASS BLADE, OR FLOWER, OR TREE. ITS PURPOSE IS TO KEEP YOU FROM TOUCHING THIS WORLD OF THE PAST IN ANY WAY. STAY ON THE PATH! DON'T GO OFF IT! I REPEAT: DON'T GO OFF IT... FOR ANY REASON! AND DON'T SHOOT ANY ANIMAL WE DON'T OKAY!
WHY?
THEY SAT IN THE ANCIENT WILDERNESS. FAR BIRDS' CRIES BLEW ON A WIND, AND THE SMELL OF TAR AND AN OLD SALT SEA, MOIST GRASSES AND FLOWERS THE COLOR OF BLOOD...
WE DON'T WANT TO CHANGE THE FUTURE. WE DON'T BELONG HERE. A TIME MACHINE IS A FINICKY BUSINESS. NOT KNOWING IT, WE MIGHT KILL AN IMPORTANT ANIMAL, A SMALL BIRD, A ROACH, A FLOWER, THUS DESTROYING AN IMPORTANT LINK IN A GROWING SPECIES.
THAT'S NOT CLEAR!



To be continued…